

All Inclusive Guide- Japan- AK

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Final Detailed Itinerary

Day	Itinerary Details
Day 1, Thurs Mar 20	● Arrive in Tokyo at 05:55 am (Haneda) ● Transfer to your hotel-Richmond Hotel Premier Tokyo Schoele. You have already booked your airport transfer from Klook. It will take you 45 mins to reach the hotel. ● Leave your bags at the hotel, have something to eat at the hotel's restaurant and then begin your day of sightseeing roughly around 10:30 am ● Visit the Senso-ji Shrine

	○ It is 12 mins from your hotel. Take Exit 1 on arrival at Asakusa station for best wheelchair accessibility. ○ It is open from 6 am till 5pm every day, free admission ○ It is wheelchair-accessible via an elevator and a ramp ○ After the visit, wander through the vibrant Nakamise-dori shopping street lined with traditional Japanese shops ● Then walk to Asakusa district (7 mins), walk around taking in the sights ○ Visit the Asakusa Culture and Sightseeing Center located opposite of the Kaminarimon. There are accessible toilets at the centre. ○ The 8th-floor observation terrace offers a nice view of Asakusa and Tokyo Sky Tree. It is free and open from 10 am to 8 pm. ○ People typically spend about an hour for the whole experience ○ There are several small food shops available, as well as experiential sit down restaurants and even Ninja cafes!- please check the eating out guide below for our top picks! ○ You can choose to have lunch here or travel to Akihabara and have lunch there (details for both are in the eating out guide) ○ <u>If you are spending more time in Asakusa</u>, you may also want to do the following: ■ View the The Asahi Beer Tower and Asahi Super Dry Hall with its characteristic Flamme d'Or were completed in 1989 and host the headquarters of Asahi Breweries. Furthermore, several restaurants can be found in the complex. Restaurants open 11:30 to 15:00 and 17:30 to 22:00. Behind both the Beer Tower and the Super Dry Hall is the Asahi Craftmanship Brewery. The restaurant and brewery offers diners decently priced lunches as well as Asahi craft beer on tap. ■ Visit Sumida Park- This riverside park stretches along both sides of Sumida River for several hundred meters ■ Visit the experiential cafes/restaurants (see in the eating out guide below) or some of the iconic options such as Kamiya Bar (one of Japan's oldest bars, with a history reaching back to 1880), Umezono (a traditional Japanese sweets shop that started in 1854. Their menu contains classics like anmitsu and oshiruko in addition to seasonal favorites like shaved ice (kakigori) and Asakusa Kagetsudo- a melon-pan store and restaurant that has been in business since 1945 ● Visit the Akihabara district (also called Electric town)- full of electronic shops and the anime central of Japan
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	○ It is 30 mins from Asakusa by metro ○ It is open 24/7 although most shops open by 10-11am. ○ Hundreds of electronics shops, ranging from tiny one-man stalls specializing in a particular electronic component to large electronics retailers, line the main Chuo Dori street ○ The only mega sized store is the Yodobashi Camera complex on the east side of the station. ○ There are also dozens of stores specializing in anime, manga, retro video games, figurines, card games and other collectibles that have filled the spaces between the electronics retailers. ○ The Akihabara branch of Don Quijote is home to the girl pop group AKB48, who perform daily shows at their theater on the 8th floor of the store ● Spend the evening at the Ueno park to view the cherry blossoms that would be in full bloom ○ It is 10 mins from Akihabara or 25 mins from the hotel (just in case you decide to now come back and check -in) ○ It is open 5am- 11pm everyday ○ Ueno Park is most easily accessed from Ueno Station's (station map) "Park Exit" which is wheelchair accessible but does have a slightly steep ramp. ○ Ueno Park is fairly wheelchair accessible, but not perfect ○ In addition to the toilets located within museums, there are several wheelchair accessible toilets located throughout the park and indicated on park maps. ● Have dinner around your hotel or around Ueno Park (check eating out guide) ● Spend the night in Tokyo
Day 2, Fri, March 21	● Start your day with a visit to Harajuku (Omote-Sando) ○ It is 45 mins by metro from the hotel. ○ Take the Exit A1 when you arrive at Omote-Sando Station for best wheelchair accessibility. ○ Harajuku is a very prominent youth fashion district- Trendy youth-oriented shops line "Cat Street" and other smaller backstreets. Meanwhile, many luxury brands have stores along Omotesando, the

main approach to Meiji Jingu Shrine.

- Approximately more than half of the stores have a step to get in
- It is hard to pinpoint accessible toilets in the shopping area, but the surefire bet is to go to either Harajuku Station or Meiji Jingu Mae Station and ask to use the station toilet (both offer accessible washrooms)

- Then visit the [Shibuya Crossing](#)

- It is 30 mins from Harajuku
- Take the Shinjuku station west exit
- Open 24/7. Anytime is a good time to visit.
- It is the busiest pedestrian intersection in the world. Witness the organized chaos as thousands of people cross from all directions in a mesmerizing display
- It is mostly accessible including the shops and the restaurants
- The safest bet for finding an accessible toilet is either within a station or at a department store. The department stores have cleaner toilets and are easier to find – many have one on each floor. However, the accessible toilets are not on the ground floor, and being a very busy area, expect to wait for the elevators

- Have lunch at [Tokyu Food Shibuchika Deli Zone](#)

- Spend the afternoon at the [Shinjuku Gyoen garden](#) to view the cherry blossoms

- It is 25 mins from Shibuya
- It is strongly recommended that wheelchair users get off at either Shinjuku Station or Shinjukusanhome Station.
- The guide maps list where accessible toilets are available, warns of areas that are gravel paths, and indicates whether paths slope up or down. This is a great resource to use when planning your route. You can download the guide from the [garden website](#).
- Unfortunately, the Japanese garden – which is the area most tourists want to visit – is entirely unpaved, and the bigger bridges have a step at the bottom. Additionally, the entrance to this area is limited by steps in a few areas. So, while it can be accessed, the Japanese Garden is a bit harder to visit than other areas.
- While the Taiwan Pavillion, Tea House Rakuu-Tei, and greenhouse are accessible, a few other buildings are not wheelchair accessible.
- The Old Imperial Rest House has a portable ramp available upon request
- It is open 9am- 4pm everyday

	● Spend the evening at Team lab borderless ○ Leave latest by 16:30 Shinjuku Gyoen by metro ○ It will take you 40 mins to reach ○ It is open from 9 am to 9 pm Sun- Mon. closed on Tuesday. ○ You have already bought tickets online for 17:30 entry ○ Guests with disabilities can get a tablet from the reception desk with accessibility maps of the facility. The maps are color-coded to show which areas are accessible and are divided by type of disability (mobility, visual, etc). Explanations for inaccessibility are also given for each room. Guests in wheelchairs are often brought to the front of the entrance line. ○ Some areas, such as the <i>Forest of Lamps</i>, are not be accessible to those in wheelchairs or other mobility devices as it is located up a flight of stairs. Other areas are not accessible due to the materials used (ie floors made from plush gym mats) or the nature of the exhibit (ie a climbing mountain or jungle gym). Additionally, some guests in wheelchairs may occasionally be asked to wait, as the number of wheelchair users admitted at one time is limited due to safety concerns. Some areas may include dark areas with uneven ground, so move cautiously. ○ An elevator is available to move between floors. It is located in a staff-only area, so asking for assistance is required. Return back to the hotel, have dinner around (refer to eating out guide below)
Day 3, Sat, Mar 22	● Take your day trip to Mt Fuji (already booked by you) ● You will be picked up by your tour guide from the hotel at 08:00 am. ● Talk to your tour guide about including visits to the Hot Springs (Kawaguchiko onsen), volcanic Owakudani valley, the pirate cruise on lake Ashi ● Have lunch during your trip at the stop in your itinerary ● Have dinner around your hotel, once you are dropped back, likely around 6pm. (refer to eating out guide below)
Day 4, Sun, Mar 23	● Check out of your hotel and leave latest at 8:15 am to arrive at Tokyo Station (30 mins from your hotel by public transport and 15 mins by cab). Book a Go cab for the same. ● Your bullet train is at 9:39 am. ● Travel to Kyoto (2h 15 mins) ● Transfer to your hotel Tokyu Stay Kyoto Sanjo-Karasuma (14 mins from Kyoto

	station by public transport and 10 mins by cab) and have lunch around (check eating out guide) ● Leave latest at 2:15 pm to reach Saga Torokko station (35 mins from the hotel) for the Sagano Train Ride. ○ Tickets are booked for 15:02 train ● Once you return back to Saga Torokko in the train (you will likely be back to the station at (15:50), head directly to Maikoya Tea House, Karasuma shijo for your traditional tea ceremony. ○ It will take you 30 minutes by cab or public transport, but cab would be recommended to reach without transfers. ○ The tea ceremony is booked at 5:00pm ○ It is 90 minutes ● Then head to Nijo Castle for the Naked Sakura show (the show is anytime from 6pm- 10 pm with last admission is at 9pm) ○ It will take 13 minutes by bus from the tea house to Nijo Castle ○ Heading to Ninomaru Palace, you will be directed to the right hand side by a staff member if you are in a wheelchair. The palace has been made accessible, but to avoid bringing in excess dirt or water, wheelchair users will need to transfer into a manual wheelchair provided by the castle. From there a ramp leads into the palace. A number of times there are small bumps/changes in elevation between rooms. ○ Returning to where wheelchairs were exchanged, the next stop is the Ninomaru Garden. As this requires passing through a gate in the wall, it is a bit uneven and wheelchair users may need to be cautious. ○ Following the garden is Honmaru, or the main circle of defense. The entrance that follows the exit from Ninomaru Garden is not accessible as there is a large step and then a flight of stairs. To enter Honomaru in a wheelchair, the entrance at the opposite side of the moat must be used. While it does not have stairs, it still has a graveled slope. ○ Wheelchair accessible toilets are available ● Have dinner around (check eating out guide) and return back to the hotel for the night
Day 5 Mon, Mar 24	● You have booked your full day Kyoto and Nara sightseeing private tour ● You will be picked up from your hotel at 9 am. <u>Accessible info for some of the sights you will be visiting:</u> ● Kinkaku-ji (Kyoto) ○ The site near the pavilion is wheelchair accessible, but much of the gardens are not. ○ Once inside the grounds, the path to the pavilion is made of gravel but

	has flat, solid ground underneath ○ Wheelchair users can view the Golden Pavilion and go to the garden behind it. Unfortunately, only a small part of the gardens are wheelchair accessible as steps block the path. ○ One wheelchair accessible toilet is available on the grounds. The accessible toilet itself is located behind the other toilets. It is very basic and has no backrest. ● Kiyomizu-Dera Temple (Kyoto) ○ Ramps are everywhere and an accessible restroom is behind the main temple and shrine; an accessible walkway and signs are visible. Around the corner from the restroom is the entrance to the main temple with the ticket counter on the right; those in wheelchairs receive a discount. The Jishu Shrine is a popular attraction right next to the main temple but the stone staircase prevents access. ● Nara Park ○ In general, the park itself is relatively flat with the occasional gradual incline. The park is landscaped with a few ponds and streams. Wheelchair accessible bathrooms can be found throughout the park. ● Todaji Temple (Nara) ○ Wheelchair access is excellent at this temple. In the middle of the cobblestone pathway to the temple is a smooth stone pathway with no cracks. Follow this to the left of the main entrance; you will see signs as well. At the ramp ring the attendant who will ask if you have a ticket or not ○ You will be given a disability discount ○ By wheelchair, you are able to travel around the perimeter to get different views but stairs prevent access to the center courtyard. ● Fushimi- Inari (Kyoto) ○ Before going to the rows of torii gates, you should visit the main shrine. The path from the main gate to the temple is smooth and easy to move on, but there is a set of stairs leading up to the main shrine hall. Heading to the left there are two other sets of stairs, but this time built with ramps. Unfortunately, the ramps are a bit steep and wheelchair users may want some assistance to get up. ○ To go to the paths with the torii gates, there is an elevator behind the main shrine and a nicely paved path at the top that leads to the start of the main torii tunnel. (Note that the elevator can only be used between 9:00-15:00.) ○ Once up the elevator, you can through the start of the torii tunnel and the double tunnel all the way to the inner okusha shrine. ○ Unfortunately, the paths begin to climb the mountain and are made of
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	stairs. Those who cannot climb stairs will need to return. The paths are directional, so after passing through the path heading upwards to get to the inner shrine, you can return down the other path which is less crowded and makes for better pictures. • Gion District ○ Gion in Kyoto is a great place to catch a glimpse of a geisha and see traditional architecture. While the streets and many shops are accessible, the majority of tea houses and traditional restaurants are inaccessible to those in wheelchairs. ○ Hanamikoji is very easy to access for those in wheelchairs. The road is flat and wide, though there are many other tourists and occasionally cars on the street, so keeping track of your surroundings can distract somewhat from the scenery. ○ Shijo Avenue has narrow sidewalks, but the stores are surprisingly very accessible with flat entrances and often have the doors left open. ○ Gion Corner has an accessible entrance as well as an accessible toilet. ● You will be dropped back to your hotel by 7pm; have dinner around (check eating out guide)
Day 6, Tues, Mar 25	● Have a leisurely morning breakfast, check out and leave your bags at the hotel and then head over to Arashiyama Bamboo Forest around 11 am ○ It will take you about 45 minutes to reach from your hotel, by public transport ○ The forest has no entrance fees, is open 24hrs and people typically spend an hour. ○ There are smooth, paved paths through the Arashiyama Bamboo Grove ensures that those in wheelchairs or other mobility aides can also enjoy the ancient atmosphere of Kyoto. ○ The Arshiyama stations have accessible toilets ○ You can easily spend an hour here ○ Have lunch at the cafes around Arashiyama. ● Travel back to the hotel, pick your bags and then travel by private transfer to Osaka from Kyoto. I would suggest to book the pickup between 3-3:30pm. ● Check into your hotel Holiday Inn Express Osaka City Centre- Midosuji (it will take you about an hour to reach) ● Head to Okawa River for the evening (40 mins from the hotel) ○ Enjoy strolling past the river flanked by about 4800 cherry blossom trees. ● Spend the rest of the evening café hopping (please refer to the eating out guide)

Day 7, Wed, Mar 26	● Have a leisurely morning ● Then visit the Osaka Castle ○ It is 35 mins away from the hotel ○ It is open 9 am - 5 pm everyday ○ It is recommended to buy your tickets in advance online ○ People typically spend 2-3 hrs ○ It has elevators and is mostly wheelchair-accessible. ● Return back to your hotel and have dinner around. ● In the evening, stroll along the Tonbori Riverwalk, take in the sights of Dotonburi a very famous and lively shopping/eating/entertainment district with neon signboards or shop in the Shinsaibashi-suji shotengai arcade or the Tenjinbashisuji Shopping Arcade ○ It is easily accessible for wheelchair users. ● Have dinner around (check eating out guide or simply explore!) and head back to the hotel for the night
Day 8, Thurs, Mar 27	● Take your day trip to Hiroshima and Miyajima (you have booked a private tour for the same). Your pickup will be at 6 am <u>Accessible info for some of the sights you will be visiting:</u> ● Hiroshima Peace Memorial Park ○ Wheelchair accessible with paved paths and ramps ● Peace Memorial Museum ○ Peace Memorial Museum" is wheelchair accessible, but there is only one lift at the entrance. So wheelchair visitors turn back the same way to the entrance. Peace memorial park is located in center of downtown ● Miyajima ○ Accessible ramps in the ferry ports. Ferries have no special facilities and space for wheelchair users, but no problem to ride. Itsukushima shrine is also wheelchair accessible. Accessible ramp are provided at the main entrance and on each step. Wheelchair users can share the same route as other visitors. Ropeway to 535m top of the island mountain is not wheelchair accessible. Enjoy waking around the shrine and the shopping arcade ● You will be dropped back to your hotel by 4pm. Freshen up and relax and step

	out for dinner around
Day 9 Fri, Mar 28	• Head to Minoo National Park in the morning • It will take 1 hrs by subway (one way) and then there is a 2 km trail from Minoo Station to Minoo Falls • The trail is recommended for people that can walk or roll for at least 3 km up and then 3 more km down a mild to moderate paved incline, although there are a few short stretches where it gets steeper • Accessible restrooms can be found at both Hankyu Minoo station and at Minoh-Kayano station. Also, near the beginning of the trail, there is a shortcut with a rest area and a wheelchair accessible restroom. • Alternatively, you can take a fun Vegan/Vegetarian Sushi Making Class • Spend the rest of the day shopping and packing
Day 10 Sat, Mar 29	• You have booked your airport transfer already for pickup at 2:30 am

Recommended Restaurants In Tokyo

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Comments	Timings	Price details
Kailash Asian Dining and Bar	Indian	5 min walk from the hotel Located in Tokyo Solamachi	11am-10:30pm Closed on Tues	1000-2000 yen per person
Tenku Lounge TOP of TREE	Continental	2 min walk from the hotel Located in Tokyo Solamachi Offers dramatic Tokyo Skytree views from the 31 st floor	11am-4pm 5pm-11pm	2000-3000 yen per person
Asakusa Chaya Tabanenoshi	Dessert Cafe	Located in Asakusa Signature dish- Matcha Crème Brulee Crepe	9 am – 7pm Thurs and Fri- 11am-6pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Asakusa Chicken	Japanese	Kaarage	11am-9pm	1-1000 yen per person
Asakusa Strawberry Daifuku	Japanese Confectionary	Strawberry Daifuku	10am- 6pm	Not specified
Feb's Coffee and Scones	Café	Located in Asakusa	8 am- 4pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Ichiran Asakusa	Ramen	Located in Asakusa Option for lunch on March 20th	10am-10pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Asakusa Gyukatsu	Japanese	Interactive and immersive dining experiences in Asakusa Option for lunch on March 20th	11am-11pm	2000-3000 yen per person

Gyoza Bar Keisuke	Dumpling restaurant	Located in Asakusa Option for lunch on March 20 th Serves veg and vegan as well	6am-2pm Closed on Mon and tues	1000-2000 yen per person
Gyumon Halal Ramen Asakusa	Ramen	Located in Asakusa Option for lunch on March 20 th Serves veg and vegan as well	12pm-10pm	2000-3000 yen per person
Kyushu Jangara Akihabara	Ramen Restaurant	Located in Asakusa Has veg/vegan Ramen options too Option for lunch on March 20 th	11am-09:45 pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Ninja Experience Café Asakusa	Café	You can dress up as a ninja Located in Asakusa Option for lunch on March 20 th	10am-9pm	Not specified
Zeera Akihabara Indian Restaurant	Indian	In Akihabara Option for lunch on March 20 th	11am-3pm 5pm-11pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Veg Kitchen	Indian	In Akihabara Option for lunch on March 20 th	11am-2:30pm 5-10pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Inshotei	Japanese	Kaiseki cuisine & bento box At Ueno Park- option for March 20 th dinner Reservations required by tabelog.com , tablecheck.com	11am-3pm 5-9pm	Not Specified
Everyones	International	2 min walk from Ueno	10am-9pm	1000-2000 yen per

cafe		Station Park Exit Square- option for March 20th dinner Known for its sandwiches and new York style cheesecake		person
Tokyu Food Shibuchika Deli Zone	Mostly Japanese options	Food court which has several eateries/restaurants 2 min walk from the Shibuya Scramble Crossing Lunch option on March 21st	Most eateries open by 9am and close at 11pm	Prices vary
Le Souffle	Dessert café- souffle	Located in Shibuya Lunch option on March 21st	11am- 5:30 pm Closed on Mon and Tues	1000-2000 yen per person
I'm Donut?	Donut Shop	Located in Shibuya Lunch option on March 21st	11am- 8pm Closed on wed	Not specified
Maccha House	Café	Located in Shibuya Lunch option on March 21st	11am- 7pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Fuglen Tokyo	Café	Located in Shibuya Cocktails, coffee & Scandinavian baked goods in a trendy, wood-paneled space with vintage decor. Lunch option on March 21st	7am- 1am	1-1000 yen per person
Maidreamin Shibuya Store	Cosplay Cafe	Located in Shibuya Fun and lively café that also has performances Lunch option on March 21st	11:30am -11pm	https://g.co/kgs/7gikn9q
Ruru Shibuya	Café	Located in Shibuya Has a unique water table concept	11am- 8:30pm	1000-2000 yen per person

		Lunch option on March 21st		
<u>Ginger Garden Aoyama</u>	Cafe	Located in Omotesando Has a special cherry blossom afternoon menu Reservations required- <u>tabelog.com</u>, <u>ozmall.co.jp</u>, <u>byfood.com</u>	11 am – 08:30 pm	Not specified
<u>Haute Couture Caffé, Omotesando</u>	Café	Sakura themed décor and afternoon tea	11am- 8:30 pm	5000-7000 yen per person

Recommended Restaurants In Kyoto

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Comments	Timings	Price details
Nakau- Kyoto Hachijo Entrance	Japanese	Near Kyoto station	8pm- 2 am	1000 yen per person
Pastamore Kyoto Station Store	Italian	Near Kyoto station	11am-9pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Kyo Chabana Kyoto Station	Japanese	Near Kyoto station Known for its Okonomiyaki	5pm-10:30pm	2000-3000 yen per person
Ippudo Kyoto Porta	Japanese	Near Kyoto station	11am-10pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Sushi No Musashi	Sushi	Near Kyoto station	10:30am- 09:20 pm	1000-3000 yen per person
Taj Mahal Everest Karasuma Oike	Indian	3 min walk from the hotel	11am- 3pm 5-10pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Gohan-ya	Izayaka	1 minute walk from the hotel Seasonal homestyle recipes and a huge sake menu	5:30pm- 10:30 pm Closed on sun	Not specified
Menya Yukou	Ramen	2 min walk from the hotel	11am- 3pm 5:30pm-10pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Kosa	New American Restaurant	3 min walk from the hotel	7-10:30 am 11:30 am- 3pm 5:30pm- 10pm	Not specified
Mr. Maurice's Italian Restaurant and Bar	Italian	3 min walk from the hotel	11:30 am- 3pm 5:30pm-9:30 pm	Not specified

Kikyo	Yakiniku	1 min walk from the hotel	11:30 am- 2pm 5:30pm- 10 pm	Not specified
Shubha Bihani - Bukkoji	Indian	14 mins walk from the hotel (shorter transit possible with metro)	11 am–3 pm 5–10 pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Sudarshan	Indian	14 mins walk from the hotel (shorter transit possible with metro)	11 am–3 pm 5 pm - 9:30 pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Spice Lounge	Indian	15 mins walk from the hotel	10 am - 11 pm	2000-3000 yen per person
Mughal Indian Restaurant and Bar	Indian	20 min walk from the hotel	Closed on Tuesdays. Other days 12-2:30 pm and 5-9 pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Ashoka Indian Resturant	Indian	20 min walk from the hotel	Open everyday 11-2:30 pm, 5-930pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Fune Ethical Lifestyle	Serves vegan dishes	15 mins walk from the hotel,	Closed on Wed. Open 12pm-6pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Restaurant Namaste	Indian, Nepalese	6 mins walk from Fushimi Inari Taisha	11 am - 10 pm	1000-2000 yen per person
New Annapurna Fukakusa	Indian	13 mins from Fushimi Inari Taisha, involves 10 mins of walking	11 am–3 pm 5–11 pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Okaffe Kyoto	Café	The head barista is a multiple-time winner of the Japan Barista Championship.	9am – 8 pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Hyoue	Kaiseki	Reservations required +81 75-741-3066	11am-4pm 6-8pm Closed on Wed	Not specified
Kumonocha	Café	Trendy café most famous for their cloud-shaped mousse cakes They are also known for	10am- 5:30 pm	1000-2000 yen per person

		their Macha based drinks and desserts		
Café Cherish	Dessert Café	The café's concept is to express a "bubble-like, unreal world" in parfaits, making them delicious and visually appealing. Their popular first-ranked parfait is the Mermaid Crystal Lagoon Parfait. They also sell original packaged tea as souvenirs	11am-5pm Closed on Mon and tues	1000-2000 yen per person
ThisisShizen	Ice cream shop	Just 3 min walk from the hotel It is a viral and unique ice cream shop in Kyoto, Japan, known for its creative and unusual flavors. They offer a variety of seasonal and original mixed ice bouquets, made with white bean paste. The shop also serves coffee and Japanese traditional danko sweets.	10am- 7pm	Not specified
Kyo Karucha Cafe	Cafe	Known for its creative cheesecake and cute latte art	10am- 7pm Closed on wed	1000-2000 yen per person
Itoh Kyuemon	Cafe	A viral café known for its Matcha Parfait Bar. It is present in more than one location	10:30 am- 6:30 pm	Not specified
Maccha House	Cafe	A viral café known for its signature- Uji Matcha Tiramisu	11am- 8pm	1000-2000 yen per person
French Café chasen	Cafe	When you open the kiribako, white mist rises, revealing 8 exquisite matcha desserts	11am- 9pm	1000-2000 yen per person

Recommended Restaurants In Osaka

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Comments	Timings	Price details
Genmai Café.	Vegan Japanese	3 min walk from your hotel English menu- The focus is on brown rice balls, but there are also curry, salad, and daily main options	Open Mon – Wed and Fri – Sun 11pm – 5pm. Closed Thursdays.	From 1045 – 1320 yen for lunch set
Tofu Sorano Minami Senba	Tofu Restaurant	3 min walk from your hotel	11:30- 3:30 pm and 5 – 10:30 pm every day	1-1000 yen per person
Chikuyotei Minamimidoten	Japanese	1 min walk from the hotel	11:30- 3:30 pm and 5 – 10:00 pm every day	Not specified
Indian Nepali Restaurant Himalayan Minamisemba	Indian	9 min walk from the hotel	11 am- 3:30 pm and 5 – 10 pm every day	1-1000 yen per person
Indian Restaurant Mira Umeda	Indian	15 min from the hotel using metro	11:15 am- 3:30 pm and 5 – 9:30 pm every day	1-1000 yen per person
Indian Restaurant Gautama	Indian	20 mins from the hotel, using metro	11am- 3pm and 5 – 11pm every day	2000-3000 yen per person
Shama Vegetarian Indian restaurant	Indian	Option when you are exploring Dotonbori.	11am- 3 pm, 5pm-10pm. Closed on Mondays	1000-2000 yen per person
Singhs Kitchen	Indian	Option when you are exploring Dotonbori	10am- 10pm everyday	1000-2000 yen per person
Mirch Masala Bollywood Indian Café, Restaurant and Bar	Indian	Option when you are exploring Dotonbori	11am- 11 pm everyday	1000-2000 yen per person

Green Earth	Vegan Japanese	Staff speaks English and there is an English menu Option when you are exploring Dotonbori	Open Mon-Thurs & Sat 11.30am – 5pm, Fri 11.30am – 3pm/ 6pm – 10pm. Closed Sunday.	1100 yen for lunch set and 950 yen for curry.
CoCo Ichibanya.	Japanese	Option when you are exploring Dotonbori they have a separate vegetarian menu—look for signs on the window or for the green menu at the tables. The regular English menu is helpful to explain the ordering process.	Various branches. Open daily 11am – 10.30pm (times may vary across branches).	Vegetarian curries from 841 yen.
Okonomiyaki Chitose	Japanese restaurant which has vegetarian options	English menu 20 min metro ride Offers the Vegetarian version of the Japanese classic	Open Thurs – Mon 11.30am – 2pm/ 4.30pm – 7pm. Closed Tuesdays and Wednesdays	1200 yen for vegetarian okonomiyaki
Rocca	Vegan Japanese	Only vegan meals available Traditional Japanese set meal. 20 mins from the hotel	Open Mon – Fri 11.30am – 2.30pm/ 5.30pm – 9pm, Sat 11.30am – 2.30pm/ 5.30pm – 8.30pm. Closed Sundays.	1300 yen for lunch set including tea.
SAKImoto bakery	Bakery and cake shop	Their shokupan (Japanese milk bread) is the highlight	9am- 7pm	1-1000 yen per person
Marufuku Coffee Sennichimae Honten	Cafe	Retro kissa with bold coffee and fluffy hotcakes	8am- 11pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Ralph's Café Shinsaibashi	Café	They serve Ralph Lauren's signature coffee blends. The salted caramel	10am- 7pm	1-1000 yen per person

		espresso milkshake is a signature		
Otto Coffee and Sweets	Cafe	They are known for their original sweets, particularly a unique "Souffle Cheesecake"	9am- 7:30pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Wad Café	Tea house	Japanese desserts and matcha delights	12pm- 7pm	Not specied
Picco Latte	Cafe	A whimsical floral themed café with beautifully decorated drinks and treats	11am- 6pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Cobatopan- kojo	Cafe	A retro bakery specializing in cute mini sandwiches with eyes	8am- 6pm Closed on wednesday	1-1000 yen per person
Lilo Coffee Roasters	Café	A trendy café known for its hand-drip coffee and artsy ambiance	11am- 11pm	1-1000 yen per person
Hoshino Coffee	Café	A classic Japanese café famous for its fluffly souffle pancakes	9 am- 10pm	1000-2000 yen per person
Gram Café	Cafe	The go -to place for insta worthy siggly souffle pancakes	10:30am- 5pm	1000-2000 yen per person

Popular Japanese dishes

- Tempura- The batter-coated seafood and vegetables are traditionally fried in sesame oil and served with either a tiny pool of salt or a dish of soy sauce-flavoured broth spiked with grated radish for dipping
- Okonomiyaki is a type of Japanese savoury pancake. made by mixing together batter, sliced cabbage, and other savoury ingredients; spooning the mixture onto a hot plate; and then pan-frying as you would a pancake.
- Sushi- raw fish served on rice seasoned lightly with vinegar.
- sashimi is raw fish or meat that has been expertly cut into thin slices and typically comes served with daikon radish, pickled ginger, wasabi and soy sauce.

- Onigiri - Triangular onigiri rice balls are a quintessential Japanese snack- Also known as ‘omusubi’, ‘nigirimeshi’, or just ‘rice balls’, onigiri are portions of Japanese rice, normally with a filling in the centre, that have been moulded into triangular or cylindrical shapes before being wrapped in nori seaweed.
- Ramen- egg noodles in a salty, meat based broth
- Udon noodles- One of the three main noodle varieties eaten in Japan. thick, chewy, and traditionally made from wheat flour and brine water. Udon can be served in a number of different ways (mixed into stir fries, added to hot pots, served cold with a [tsuyu](#) or tentsuyu soup base on the side for dipping), but are most commonly used in noodle soups
- Soba- long, thin buckwheat noodles. The noodles are served in either a hot, soy sauce-flavoured broth, or at room temperature on a bamboo mat with broth on the side for dipping.
- Unagi- river eel, usually grilled over charcoal and lacquered with a sweet barbecue sauce.
- Gyoza- savoury moon-shaped dumplings, made from a minced mixture of savoury fillings (pork mince, cabbage, green onion and mushroom is a common combination)
- Mochi- Wonderfully chewy and stretchy, mochi rice cakes are made from pounded steamed rice and often stuffed with sweet bean paste. You can find all kinds of delicious varieties, from sticky sakura mochi to strawberry daifuku mochi, each made with entirely plant-based ingredients.
- Wagashi- More like works of art than food, wagashi sweets are an unmissable Japanese treat. Traditionally made with only plant-based ingredients such as bean paste, they’re beautifully crafted in the shape of flowers and other stunning designs. For a truly authentic experience, enjoy them with a cup of matcha tea!
- Shabu-shabu is the Japanese onomatopoeia for the sound of thin slices of beef or pork being swished around with chopsticks in bubbling broth
- Tonkatsu- breaded and deep-fried pork cutlet
- Yakitori- small skewers of bite-size chicken pieces seasoned with salt or brushed with a sauce, or tare, of mirin rice wine, soy sauce, sake alcohol, and sugar.
- Donburi- Donburi is made by preparing (normally by simmering or frying) various meat, fish and vegetables and serving over steamed rice in large bowls (also called ‘donburi’).
- Tamagoyaki- A versatile delicacy that can be enjoyed for breakfast, lunch, or dinner, tamagoyaki (which literally means ‘cooked egg’) is a Japanese omelette made by sequentially cooking and rolling up several layers of beaten egg (sometimes seasoned with soy sauce and/or sugar).
- Kashi Pan- the word ‘kashipan’ means ‘sweet bread’, and it refers to a range of single-serve bread buns that were originally invented in Japan. Among the most popular of these are melon pan (a bread bun with a cookie dough top), an pan (a bread bun filled with an or anko; a sweet red bean paste), and karee pan or kare pan (a bread bun filled with curry sauce, covered in panko breadcrumbs, and deep-fried). Kashipan are a must-try for bread lovers in particular.

- Miso Soup- Made from a combination of miso paste (a traditional Japanese food made from fermented soy beans) and dashi broth, miso soup is served as a side dish with traditional Japanese-style breakfasts, lunches and dinners.
- Mentaiko- This salty delicacy is made by marinating the roe (fish eggs) of pollock and cod in any of a number of salty, savoury, and spicy seasonings
- Nikujaga- A flavoursome savoury dish of meat, potatoes and assorted vegetables simmered in soy sauce, sake, mirin and sugar,
- Curry Rice- Japanese curry differs from the Indian varieties with which the UK is more familiar, in that it is generally sweeter in flavour, thicker in texture, and prepared more like a stew (with meat and vegetables being cooked by boiling in water together).
- Shabu Shabu hot pot- made by boiling vegetables, tofu and other ingredients in a mellow broth seasoned with kombu kelp, and then dipping very thin slices of meat into the broth and swishing the meat around until it cooks (normally around 10-20 seconds
- Yakisoba- fried noodle dish made by barbecuing or stir-frying a combination of noodles, sliced cabbage, pork, carrot and other vegetables, and a barbecue style yakisoba sauce.
- Chawanmushi- This steamed, savoury egg custard is made by pouring seasoned, beaten eggs into individual cups already filled with different meats and vegetables (including chicken, mushrooms, ginkgo nuts, kamaboko fish cakes, and carrots), and then steaming the cups in a pot or steamer until they have solidified and become similar to pudding in texture.
- Wagashi- Wagashi are traditional Japanese sweets, invented during the Edo period and influenced by prevalent Japanese ingredients and flavours. Most wagashi are made using only a handful of select ingredients, including mochi rice cakes, anko paste, kanten (agar; a vegetarian thickener similar to gelatine), chestnuts, and sugar.

Japanese Vegetarian dishes

- Tempura- deep fried vegetables in batter
- Ukemono or Japanese pickled vegetables are an essential part of a Japanese meal and are always included in set meals.
- Miso soup (often with tofu and green onions) is part of every set meal including breakfast. Chopsticks are used to eat the ingredients and the broth is sipped directly from the bowl.
- Zaru Soba- Cold soba (buckwheat) noodles are popular in the summer served on a bamboo tray with nori seaweed, spring onion, wasabi
- Okonomiyaki is a type of Japanese savoury pancake. It is usually made with egg so please try the ones only at vegan restaurants.
- Nasu dengaku- This classic Japanese side dish consists of grilled eggplant cut into slices and coated with a delicious, rich miso glaze.
- Veg Sushi- lots of sushi in Japan is vegetarian. Look out for treats such as *kappa maki* (cucumber rolls), *takuan maki* (pickled daikon rolls) and *inarizushi* (rice stuffed inside deep-fried tofu pockets).
- Vegetarian onigiri- Triangular onigiri rice balls are a quintessential Japanese snack, and several of them are vegetarian. Keep an eye out for ones filled with kombu seaweed, *umeboshi* (pickled plum), and *natto* (fermented soybeans).
- Vegetarian ramen
- Veg udon noodles
- Veg gyoza (veg momos)
- Mochi- Wonderfully chewy and stretchy, mochi rice cakes are made from pounded steamed rice and often stuffed with sweet bean paste. You can find all kinds of delicious varieties, from sticky sakura mochi to strawberry daifuku mochi, each made with entirely plant-based ingredients.
- Wagashi- More like works of art than food, wagashi sweets are an unmissable Japanese treat. Traditionally made with only plant-based ingredients such as bean paste, they're beautifully crafted in the shape of flowers and other stunning designs. For a truly authentic experience, enjoy them with a cup of matcha tea!

Additional tips as vegetarians in Japan

- You could try telling people that you are vegetarian (“*Watashi wa bejitarian des*”) but they probably won’t understand exactly what this means.
- It is better to instead say- “*watashi wa niku toh sakana wo tabemasen*” which means I don’t eat meat or fish.
- Download the Google Translate app and use the speech to text feature to communicate what you want to.
- You can also use the camera feature on Google Translate app to go through menus that may not be in English
- Avoid Dashi (a popular condiment used in dipping sauces) since it contains fish sauce
- Look out for Coco Ichibanya- japan’s largest curry chain- which is available in most places and use the green menus (veg) to order.

Important Places Around Your Hotels

TOKYO- Richmond Hotel Premier Tokyo Schole

Convenience stores

- [Family Mart](#) (3 min walking distance from the hotel)

Pharmacy

- [Pharmacy](#) (2 min walking distance from the hotel)

Hospital

- [San-ikukai Hospital](#) (3 min drive by car from the hotel)
- [Tokyo Hikifune Hospital](#) (3 min drive by car from the hotel)

Indian embassy Tokyo

- [Embassy of India](#)

KYOTO- Tokyu Stay Kyoto Sanjo-Karasuma

Convenience stores

- [7-Eleven](#) (1 min walking distance from the hotel)

Pharmacy

- [アインメディアオ 京都営業所 Nakagyo Ward, Kyoto](#) (3 min walking distance from the hotel)
- [Welcia DACS Kyōto Oike Shop](#) (6 min walking distance from the hotel)

Hospital

- [Kyoto Shinmachi Hospital](#) (6 min walking distance from the hotel)
- [Japanese Red Cross Kyoto Daini Hospital](#) (3 min drive by car from the hotel)

OSAKA- Holiday Inn Express Osaka City Centre- Midosuji

Convenience stores

- [FamilyMart](#) (3 min walking distance from the hotel)
- [7-Eleven Osaka Midosuji Honmachi](#) (4 min walking distance from the hotel)

Pharmacy

- [OS Drug Shin-Semba](#) (3 min walking distance from the hotel)

- [Sun Drug](#) (3 min walking distance from the hotel)

Hospital

- [Ohno Memorial Hospital](#) (5 min drive by car from the hotel)
- [Nippon Life Hospital](#) (6 min drive by car from the hotel)

Mobile Connectivity while in Japan

There are 4 main SIM Card providers in Japan, but **I would recommend NTT Docomo** for better coverage

- The best place to buy a sim card is at the airport kiosks
- You can also buy it at a convenience store
- Even if you do not purchase an international roaming plan for your current India number, remember to activate roaming so that you receive messages (important for things like OTPs).

Emergency Numbers

Here are few numbers to keep handy while in Japan

- 110: Police
- 119: Ambulance

Getting around in Japan.

- Buy a prepaid Icoca/Suica/Pasmo card for local travel (railways/buses/subways) in all Japanese cities.
- It is recommended to buy the card from the closest metro station to you
- The ICOCA Card costs **¥2,000**, which includes ¥1,500 in preloaded value and a ¥500 deposit that you can get back when you return the card at the end of your trip.
- Suica card also has refundable deposit.
- Pasmo doesn't have refundable deposit.
- You can recharge the card from automated ticket machines, charge machines, and fare adjustment machines inside ticket gates and even convenience stores.
- Your current credit balance will be displayed on a small screen when you pass through ticket gates or make a payment at a store. Additionally, you can check your balance and view your usage history at ticket machines.
- You need 1 card per person
- Typically consider 1000-2000 yen per day but since you have a couple of private trips, I would suggest to first load the card with 5000 yen and then recharge as you go.
- We would suggest to read through the following article to understand how to use it
<https://www.klook.com/en-IN/blog/icoca-card-guide/>

Recommended things to buy/carry

- Travel Insurance- Recommendation- TATA AIG
- Light jackets (the current weather ranges from 3 degrees to 21 degrees)
- Umbrellas for the occasional shower
- Caps and sunscreen for when the sun is out!!
- Walking shoes
- Travel adaptors for chargers
- Forex (cash and card). Recommendation for a forex card is a BookMyForex card
- Doctors prescriptions/travel prescriptions for medicines (except over the counter meds)

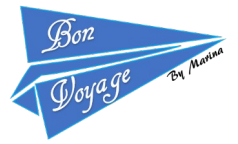
Recommended Apps

- Google Translate
- Google Maps- please click on the map link for each destination on your itinerary and hit 'directions' with the start point as 'my location' Don't forget to click on 'options' and choose 'wheelchair accessible' to give you the closest bus stops/metro stations that are accessible.
- Go Taxi
- Happy Cow (to look for veg restaurants)
- Klook (to manage your bookings)
- Get your guide (to manage your bookings)

Common Japanese Phrases

Japanese Word	Pronunciation	Meaning in English
Konnichiwa	<i>kohn-nee-chee-wah</i>	Hello
Arigatou Gozaimasu	<i>ah-ree-gah-toh goh-zah-ee-mahs</i> Thank	Thank You
Sumimasen	<i>soo-mee-mah-sen</i>	Excuse me/ Im sorry
Hai	<i>Hi</i>	Yes
Īe	<i>ee-eh</i>	No
Hajimemashite	<i>hah-jee-meh-mah-shee-teh</i>	Nice to meet you
Sayōnara	<i>sah-yoh-nah-rah</i>	Goodbye
Nihonshu	<i>nee-hohn-shoo</i>	Japanese Sake
Okaikei onegaishimasu	<i>oh-kai-kay oh-neh-guy shee-mahs</i>	Bill, please
o Kudasai	<i>oh koo-dah-sigh</i>	I would like __, please

We would recommend downloading the Google Translate app and you can use the text to speech feature as well.



You can also use the camera settings on the app to go through menus that aren't in English or when you are shopping for something!

What to buy as souvenirs and from where?

Type of souvenir	Category	Where to buy
Wagashi (Japanese confectionery)	Consumables	Izutsu
Mochi (made of glutinous rice, sugar, cornstarch)		Izutsu, supermarkets
Yatsushashi (made of glutinous rice, sugar, cornstarch and cinnamon)		Kyoto speciality but can also be found in supermarkets in Tokyo
Unique Kitkat flavours		supermarkets, Don Quijote stores, or some KitKat Chocolatory shops
Rice crackers or wasabi peas		Supermarkets
Green tea (Sencha -bitter flavour; Gyokuro sweet flavour; Matcha umami; hojicha toasty)		For high-quality tea, consider visiting specialty tea shops such as Tsujiri, Ippodo and Fukujen. Many department stores
Traditional sake or umeshu , a delightful Japanese liqueur.		Department stores
Chopsticks	Traditional Japanese items	Tokyu Hands Hands Kyoto
		Loft in Tokyo and Osaka
		Daiso
Sensu fan		Kyosendo
Daruma dolls/kokeshi dolls/koboshi dolls		Souvenir shops
Woodblock prints		Souvenir shops
A goshuincho is a stamp book that travelers fill with stamps and calligraphy		Souvenir shops

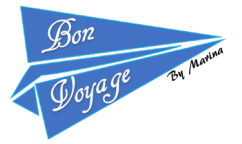
Omamori are Japanese amulets thought to provide various forms of luck or protection .		Every temple will have a different one
The maneki-neko, or “beckoning cat,” is a common talisman believed to bring good luck and fortune to its owner.		Speciality, souvenir shops
Manga volumes and anime DVDs, figurines, clothing, toys, and other themed merchandise	Manga and Anime	Akihabara and Nakano Broadway
		Pokémon Centers, Nintendo stores, and
		JUMP shops across Japan for merchandise.
Japanese skincare, makeup, and haircare products are recognized for their quality and variety	Beauty and cosmetics	Department stores and local pharmacies Cosme Tokyo Shu Uemura Flagship Store Omotesando (Harajuku)
Pens, notebooks, stickers, stamps, decorative tapes, cute erasers, or art supplies	Stationery can be ideal souvenirs for artists, and stationery lovers	Tokyu Hands Loft Also available in Kyoto Hands and Loft, Umeda (Osaka)
Clothes	Garments	Uniqlo Tokyo and Osaka Harajuku (Cat Street) Onitsuka Tiger (Omotesando, Harajuku) Fender (Shibuya)

Thank You!

Thank you for trusting us with the opportunity to plan your vacation!

We hope your trip is filled with unforgettable memories and special moments together.

Remember, we're always here to assist you—before, during, and even after your journey. Just a call or message away!



Bon Voyage By Marina - 86000-15316